

LittleReads

The Kindness Jar

Friendship

Ages 5–7

by LittleReads Editorial Team

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When they were in the back of the bus, it felt like they were in a different world. The other students were kind, and different. They played games and sang songs. And they did not know anyone.

Chapter 1: The First Stone

On her first day, Amara sat next to a girl named Chioma, who looked sad.

"Are you okay?" Amara asked.

"I lost my crayons," said Chioma. "I cannot do my drawing."

Amara thought for a moment. Then she broke her own crayon set in half and shared it with Chioma.

"Thank you!" said Chioma, smiling for the first time.

That night, Amara put the first stone in her jar.

"One kind act today," she told her mother. "I shared my crayons."

"How did it feel?" her mother asked.

"Good," said Amara. "It felt really good."

Chapter 2: More Stones

The next day, Amara helped a younger child find their classroom. Stone.

The day after that, she said "good morning" to the school guard who always looked lonely. Stone.

Then she helped clean up after lunch when no one else would. Stone.

And when she saw a boy sitting alone at break time, she invited him to play. Stone.

Every evening, Amara dropped a stone in the jar and thought about the kind things she had done.

The jar was filling up slowly, one stone at a time.

Chapter 3: Something Amazing

Something strange was happening at school. Amara noticed that Chioma was being kind to others too.

"I saw how you shared your crayons with me," Chioma said. "So I shared my snacks with someone today."

And the boy Amara had invited to play — he helped another child carry their books.

It was like kindness was contagious. One kind act led to another, which led to another.

Amara's jar was almost full. But the kindness at school was just beginning.

Chapter 4: The Full Jar

After one month, Amara's jar was completely full of stones.

She brought it to show her mother, beaming.

"Look, Mama! Every stone is a kind thing I did!"

Her mother held the jar up to the light. It was heavy and beautiful, the stones shining like jewels.

"Amara, look at this jar. When you started, it was empty. But every small act of kindness added something beautiful."

"Mama, I think kindness is like the jar. When you start with nothing, but keep adding, it becomes something wonderful."

Her mother hugged her tightly. "That is exactly right, my love."

Chapter 5: The Ripple Effect

By the end of the term, Amara had made more friends than she could count. Not because she was the loudest or the smartest, but because she was the kindest.

Chioma, the guard, the younger children, the lonely boy — they were all her friends now.

And every one of them had started their own kindness jar.

The classroom teacher, Mrs. Eze, put a large jar in the middle of the classroom. "Let us fill this together," she said.

And they did. One stone, one kind act, one smile at a time.

Because kindness does not just fill a jar. It fills hearts, classrooms, and the whole world.

What We Learned

- Small acts of kindness can make a big difference.
- Kindness is contagious — it inspires others to be kind too.
- Being kind helps you make friends.
- Even one person can start something beautiful.

Discussion Questions

1. What kind things have you done today?
2. How did it feel when someone was kind to you?
3. Can you start your own kindness jar at home?

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Thank you for reading!

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